THE CAREGIVER'S SECRET · MOBILE STORY EXTENSION

Under the Plate

A vertical companion series from NCCA Entertainment

Eight episodes. One night caregiver. Three months before Dana.

FORMAT	EPISODES	LEAD	RELATIONSHIP
Vertical 9:16 series	8, about 90 to 120 seconds	Theresa Hollis	Standalone story, shared world

LOGLINE

> *When a night caregiver realizes the silenced former senator in her care is trying to tell her something, she starts writing down what she sees, and the family that employs her starts writing something else.*

THE STORY

Three months before Dana Reyes comes through the gate, Theresa Hollis takes the night job at the Whitfield estate. Eleanor has had a stroke and cannot speak. The foundation brochure says the house has everything she needs. Theresa checks. Each episode she notices one more thing that isn't there: a working alarm, a lift, a camera in the one room that has none, and a housekeeper who warns her not to chart what she sees.

The series ends the morning the agency stops calling, as Theresa tapes her number under a kitchen plate for whoever comes next. The next thing the audience sees is a car at the gate, which is the first image of the movie.

EPISODE GUIDE

Each episode ends on a discovery. No episode shows Dana. No episode is set outside the feature's locations except a short agency office scene.

EP	TITLE / TIME	LOCATION	THE BEAT	ENDS ON
1	**House Rules** 1:45	Whitfield foyer and kitchen	Priscilla gives Theresa the tour: cameras in every room except Mother's, for her dignity.	Theresa tests the bed alarm. The battery compartment is empty.
2	**Paid in Full** 1:30	Terrace and kitchen	A foundation brochure says the accessibility lift is installed. Theresa asks to take Eleanor outside.	On the counter, a vendor invoice stub: HARBOR ACCESS PARTNERS. PAID.
3	**Left Hand** 1:40	Eleanor's room, night	Eleanor presses Theresa's palm with her left fingers. A pattern. Again.	Three presses, a pause, three presses. Theresa writes it down.
4	**Don't Chart That** 1:35	Kitchen	Margot sees the notebook and slides a dish towel over it. In this house, you write what the family signs.	The kitchen dome's red light swings toward the table where she wrote.
5	**Order Change** 1:30	Eleanor's room, dawn	A new medication order, in Priscilla's handwriting, signed by Dr. Vance. Theresa questions the dose.	Priscilla: He has reviewed it. Theresa photographs the page.
6	**Complaint** 1:50	Agency office	The agency supervisor reads a family complaint: overstepping her clinical role.	The complaint is dated the day Theresa first asked about the lift.
7	**One Copy** 1:45	Staff lot and gate	Theresa copies the photos to a drive. At the gate, Ray searches her bag.	Ray hands the bag back. The drive is in the lining of Eleanor's tea tin.
8	**Under the Plate** 2:00	Kitchen and gate, dawn	The agency calls: reassigned. Theresa tapes her number under a plate in the cabinet while Margot looks away.	At the gate camera, a car comes up the drive. A new nurse.

WHY THERESA CARRIES IT

- She is the one supporting character whose story happens before the movie starts, so the extension adds story instead of retelling the feature.
- Her feature function is a warning from outside the gate. The extension gives that warning a cost: eight episodes of her noticing, and a job lost for it.
- Viewers meet Margot, Priscilla and Ray first. When Dana enters the house in the movie, the audience already knows what is wrong and who will lie.
- Built-in cliffhanger device: every episode, she writes down one more thing.

PRODUCTION PLAN

- **Shoots inside the feature.** Scheduled on the estate's kitchen, Eleanor's room, terrace and gate days with a second camera framed for 9:16.
- **One new setup.** An agency office, dressed from a conference room. About two shoot days of extra coverage, folded into the existing schedule.
- **Uses the feature cast.** Theresa leads. Priscilla, Margot, Adrian, Ray and Eleanor appear in short scenes. Dana is never shown. Extension days are written into cast deals up front.
- **Eleanor's work stays physical.** Left hand, eyes and breath, no dialogue.

PARTNERS AND CAUSE

- **Producing partner.** NCCA would pitch this with a vertical producing partner attached rather than as a request for Lifetime to build it.
- **No product placement.** This is a story about elder neglect and fraud, so no brand lives inside it.
- **Cause partner instead of a sponsor.** An elder-abuse prevention or family-caregiver support organization, to be confirmed. Each episode closes on a resource card, and the hotline is verified before release.

ROLLOUT INTO THE PREMIERE

Two weeks out	Episodes 1 to 3 release together so viewers can binge the setup.
Following week	Episodes 4 to 7, one every other day.
Premiere day	Episode 8 drops that afternoon and ends on the car at the gate. The movie opens hours later on the same car.
Premiere night	End-card campaign invites caregivers to share what they wish the next one had known.